

Impact High · Difficulty Medium · Misuse risk The main failure mode is sounding like a therapist, repeating words back mechanically

THE MOVE

Hear the words -> identify the core meaning or feeling -> reflect it briefly -> pause for correction -> proceed. -> Short form: notice -> name or respond -> invite -> calibrate -> release. -> So the main thing is that the plan changed after you'd ?

START HERE

Use one sentence: "So the main thing is..." or "It sounds like the frustrating part was..."

SAY THIS

Quick openers	"So the main thing is..."
Warm / supporting	"So the hard part wasn't just what happened, but how alone it felt."
Professional	"So the main concern is the decision process, not just the outcome."
Checking understand...	"Let me check I've got this: the problem is the change, not the work itself."
Tentative / course-co...	"I might have this wrong, but it sounds like the timing is the real issue."
Disagreement / press...	"Before I respond, let me make sure I've understood your concern."

AVOID

- The person needs urgent action, not reflection
- You are guessing too far beyond the evidence
- Reflection would sound patronising

REMEMBER

Reflect the point under the words, not every word.